



# David Kowalski

Game Developer | Unity & Unreal Engine Specialist

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## Online Presence

 **LinkedIn**

@davidkowalski

 **itch.io**

@dkowalski

## Professional Summary

Passionate game developer with 5+ years of professional experience creating engaging gameplay systems and polished player experiences across multiple platforms. Specialized in Unity and Unreal Engine with strong expertise in C#, C++, and game design principles.

## Technical Skills

### **Unity Engine**

Expert

C#, Editor Tools, Performance Profiling



### **Programming Languages**

Expert

C#, C++, Python, HLSL/GLSL



### **Unreal Engine**

Advanced

C++, Blueprints, UE5 Features



### **Game AI**

Advanced

Behavior Trees, FSM, Pathfinding, Navigation



## Education

### **University of Washington**

Computer Science

Bachelor of Science • 3.6 GPA

Seattle, WA • 2014 - 2018

Concentration in Game Development. Relevant Coursework: Game Engine Architecture, Computer Graphics, Artificial Intelligence, Physics Simulation, 3D Mathematics, Software Engineering, Data Structures & Algorithms

## Professional Experience

### **Cascade Studios**

Senior Game Developer

Seattle, WA

March 2022 - Present

- Lead gameplay programmer on an unannounced AAA action-adventure title built in Unreal Engine 5 for PC and next-gen consoles
- Architected and implemented core combat system including hit detection, combo mechanics, and enemy AI behavior trees serving 15+ enemy types
- Developed custom editor tools in C++ that reduced level designer iteration time by 40% and improved workflow efficiency across the team

### **Pixel Forge Interactive**

Game Developer

Bellevue, WA

June 2020 - February 2022

- Core developer on 'Starbound Odyssey,' a sci-fi roguelike that achieved 500K+ sales on Steam with 'Very Positive' user reviews
- Implemented procedural generation systems for level layouts, enemy encounters, and loot drops using Unity and C#
- Designed and programmed player progression systems including skill trees, equipment upgrades, and meta-progression mechanics
- Created robust save/load system supporting cloud saves and cross-platform play between PC and Nintendo Switch

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                              |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Notable Projects      | <b>Echoes of the Void (Indie Game)</b> 2023 - Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                              |
|                       | Solo developer for a narrative-driven 2D platformer built in Unity. Features custom dialogue system, branching story paths, and atmospheric pixel art. Currently in development with demo released on itch.io garnering 5K+ downloads and positive community feedback. Planned Steam release Q2 2025. |                                              |
|                       | <a href="#">View on itch.io</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                              |
|                       | <b>Open Source: Unity Dialogue Framework</b> 2021 - 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                              |
|                       | Created and maintain an open-source dialogue system for Unity with visual node-based editor, localization support, and voice acting integration. Project has 800+ GitHub stars and is actively used by indie developers worldwide. Includes comprehensive documentation and example projects.         |                                              |
|                       | <a href="#">View on GitHub</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                              |
|                       | <b>Game Jam Participation</b> 2019 - Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                              |
|                       | Regular participant in Ludum Dare and Global Game Jam events. Created 12+ game prototypes exploring experimental mechanics and art styles. Won 'Best Gameplay' award at Ludum Dare 48 with puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' that ranked in top 5% overall.                                             |                                              |
|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                              |
| Community Involvement | <b>Seattle Indies</b> 2020 - Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                              |
|                       | Seattle, WA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                              |
|                       | Active member of local indie game development community. Organize monthly game showcases and provide mentorship to aspiring game developers through code reviews and technical guidance.                                                                                                              |                                              |
|                       | <b>Code.org Game Development Workshops</b> 2021 - Present                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                              |
|                       | Seattle, WA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                              |
|                       | Volunteer instructor teaching basic game programming concepts to middle school students. Led 8+ workshops introducing Unity fundamentals and game design principles.                                                                                                                                  |                                              |
| References            | Available upon request                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                              |
| Certifications        | <b>Unity Certified Expert: Programmer</b> March 2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                              |
|                       | Unity Technologies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                              |
|                       | <b>Unreal Engine 5 C++ Developer</b> June 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                              |
|                       | Epic Games (Udemy)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                              |
|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                              |
| Awards & Recognition  | <b>Best Gameplay - Ludum Dare 48</b> April 2021                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                              |
|                       | Ludum Dare                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                              |
|                       | Awarded for puzzle game 'Deeper and Deeper' which ranked in the top 5% overall among 3,000+ submissions                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                              |
|                       | <b>Employee Excellence Award</b> December 2021                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                              |
|                       | Pixel Forge Interactive                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                              |
|                       | Recognized for exceptional contributions to 'Starbound Odyssey' development and dedication to code quality                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                              |
| Languages             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                              |
|                       | <b>English</b><br>Native<br>● ● ● ● ●                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Polish</b><br>Conversational<br>● ● ● ○ ○ |
| Interests             |  <b>Game Design</b><br>Mechanics, Level Design, Player Psychology                                                                                                                                                  |                                              |

 **AI & Procedural Generation**

PCG, Machine Learning, Emergent Gameplay

 **Indie Game Development**

Solo Dev, Game Jams, Community

 **Technical Art**

Shaders, VFX, Optimization

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**Publications & Talks**

**Optimizing Unity Games for Mobile: A Practical Guide** September 2021

Game Developer Magazine

Technical article covering mobile optimization techniques including draw call batching, LOD systems, and memory management

**Building Modular Dialogue Systems** May 2022

Seattle Indie Game Developers Meetup

Presented talk on designing flexible dialogue systems for narrative games, attended by 60+ local developers